

that run around on the trading floor. We don't technically need human traders to execute deals or make trades anymore thanks to technology; however, keeping the trading floor open continues as a sort of tradition. It also provides news sources great visual content of panicked and stressed-out traders for when the stock market drops slightly.

Remember that an exchange can be thought of as simply a list of companies. Companies are limited to the exchange that lists them. If you want to invest in British Petroleum you'd invest through the London Stock Exchange. If you want to invest in Samsung you'd go through the Korea Exchange. Whichever company you want, you have to find the exchange it comes from and go there.

Thankfully, gone are the days when you had to call brokers that worked on these exchanges in order to invest. (As a millennial who's petrified of phone calls, I hate to admit this was one of the barriers that stopped me from investing for a long time.)

Instead there are things called online brokers. We get into brokers in 'Putting it all together', but the main takeaway here is that stock exchanges hold the companies you're interested in, the stock market is made up of the exchanges and you invest in the stock market through brokers. Simple — see [figure 4.2](#).

The stock market, though it appears complex and intricate, is really quite simple. The industry has done an amazing job at complicating it and using jargon to push people out. It reminds me a lot of the type of girl in high school who wouldn't tell you where she got her dress from. Except now you can take a photo of the dress and use an app to scan online clothing shops (or, in our case, read a book about investing and have it broken down for us). The beauty of this modern world is that the walls of secrecy built around industries are beginning to collapse, opening them up to everyday people who want to learn about how to build generational wealth. Now that these walls are falling, it's time to step in.